

THE FIRST GREAT, REALISTIC STEP HAS BEEN TAKEN

"to forestall the plan of the Nazis to exterminate all the Jews and other persecuted minorities in Europe"

By Setting Up the War Refugee Board

President Roosevelt has answered the call of millions of defenseless men, women and children. The voice of an aroused public has been heard.

With an Executive Order, issued on Saturday, January 22, 1944, the President created the WAR REFUGEE BOARD composed of the Secretaries of State, Treasury and War, "to take action for the immediate rescue from the Nazis of as many as possible of the persecuted minorities of Europe... from enemy savagery."

This is the beginning of action which Americans of every creed and in all walks of life have long urged. This official governmental agency, created for a specific approach to one of modern civilization's gravest problems, has within it the seeds of magnificent accomplishment. At long last, we have begun the "Battle Against Massacre." It is with a sense of deepest pride that the world's greatest democracy.

This Is Still a Race Against Death. No Time Must Be Lost!

Right now... every day and every hour... the Nazis are killing hundreds and thousands of human beings only because they are Jews. They are doing this today!

We who have advocated specific government machinery to deal with this urgent problem want most earnestly and solemnly to point out that the President's call for immediate action must be implemented with action. That is why this Committee has so vigorously sponsored a resolution introduced in the Senate on November 9, 1943, by Senator Guy M. Gillette of Iowa on behalf of himself and eleven colleagues, and introduced in the House by Representatives Will Rogers, Jr. of California, and Joseph

C. Baldwin of New York, "recommending and urging the creation by the President of a commission of diplomatic, economic and military experts to formulate and effectuate a plan of immediate action designed to save the surviving Jewish people of Europe from extinction at the hands of Nazi Germany."

Clearly, the time for discussion is behind us. The time for action is here. Better an imperfect program today than a perfect program tomorrow when there may only be corpses left to be rescued!

In keeping with the President's order authorizing "the board and the State, Treasury and War Departments... to accept the services or contributions of any private persons, private organizations, State agencies or agencies of foreign governments in carrying out the purposes of this order," we respectfully suggest the specific program outlined in the column on the left, hoping that it may in some way assist the WAR REFUGEE BOARD to arrive at concrete plans at the earliest possible moment. It is offered in the product of experts from many fields, who have intensively devoted their time and experience to it. If it helps to save a month, a week, a day, it will have served a great purpose.

As Americans, we are most grateful to the President for having created the governmental machinery which makes possible a concrete program of action to save the Jews of Europe.

We are most gratified that the President has placed the responsibility for swift and effective action by the WAR REFUGEE BOARD in the hands of the distinguished statesmen, Secretaries Hull, Morgenthau and Stimson, whose deep sense of humanitarianism is universally recognized.

We look with high hope and confidence to the WAR REFUGEE BOARD under this capable leadership to develop an immediate program of action, commensurate with the magnitude of the problem.